

HISTORY
SHEETERS

OSAMA BIN LADEN Son of a Saudi tycoon. Helped the Mujahideen in fighting Soviets in Afghanistan. Founded Al Qaeda to drive Americans and American influence out of all Muslim nations and establish an Islamic nation. Has a \$25 million reward. Believed to be hiding in the Af-Pak region.



AYMAN AL-ZAWAHIRI The Egypt-born physician is No. 2 in the Qaeda hierarchy. He too is believed to be hiding in the Af-Pak region.



HAFEZ SAIED Founder of the Lashkar-e-Toiba and mastermind of the Mumbai 26/11 attack. Also runs the Jamaat-ud-Dawa, a front for the LeT. India has asked for his extradition.



KHALID SHEKH MOHAMMED The Kuwaiti-Pakistani is the main conspirator behind the 9/11 attacks; now facing trial in New York.

His nephew Ramzi Yousef tried to bomb the WTC in 1993.



OMAR SHEKH British-born Pakistani terrorist who was released in exchange for the passengers of the hijacked Indian Airlines IC-814. Sentenced to death for beheading the Wall Street Journal's Daniel Pearl in 2002.



SPIN-OFFS

Action
Replay

24

An American TV series. Kiefer Sutherland stars as Agent Jack Bauer who heads a counter-

terrorism unit preventing terror attacks on the US.

Af-Pak

A term coined by the Obama administration for Afghanistan and Pakistan. Mostly used to refer to the badlands between the two countries where Al Qaeda

and the Taliban hold sway.

Combat Drone

The unmanned combat aerial vehicle (UCAV) or 'combat drone' as they are known are being used by the CIA to eliminate Taliban and Al Qaeda leaders. They are far more precise than UAVs like the

Predator and Reaper.

WMDs

Weapons of Mass Destruction. The US claimed Saddam Hussain possessed them and invaded Iraq in their quest. Iraq did not have them but terror groups may soon get hold of these.

gather intelligence about suspect vehicles and patterns of vehicle movements, or to build defensive patterns around vulnerable areas or high profile events. Should the worst happen and an attack get through, they have proved invaluable in helping to identify and track the terrorists. In one case in London, they even enabled us to find an unexploded car bomb. Of course, all of this is only any use if it is fully integrated into a command and control system that is clear, universally understood and capable of delivering critical decisions quickly.

But what of the future? I am afraid I find it very difficult to be optimistic. Although counter-terrorist forces across the world have scored many successes during the past decade, and the military campaign in Afghanistan has done much to degrade Al Qaeda's ability to communicate and direct operations as they did prior to 9/11, the fact remains that terrorists will pose a threat to us all for many years to come. The ideology that drives it remains, the determination to kill in support of that ideology is as strong as ever, and the spread of violent extremism across continents continues. The global origins, reach and ambition of terrorist groups are clear to see.

The methodology and targeting of Al Qaeda and associated groups has been surprisingly repetitive and, to an extent, predictable. Time and again they have returned to their favoured targets of transport networks, hotels and shopping areas, night-clubs and other places where they can achieve their ambition of inflicting the maximum casualties. The killing has by and large been indiscriminate, and as often as not there have been simultaneous attacks carried out by suicidal terrorists. There is no reason to think this will change. The style of attack we saw in Mumbai in November

2008 was simply an extraordinarily brutal extension of this theme. It was not, as some commentators have suggested, an entirely new terrorist phenomenon. For instance, some of the attacks in Saudi Arabia against residential compounds have been very similar, with multiple attackers forcing entry and then indulging in an orgy of killing over an extended period of time.

However, we must not constrain our planning by imagining that terrorists will not adapt and change. The spectre of chemical, biological and nuclear terrorism is very real. They have long held ambitions in these areas, and it would be foolhardy not to prepare. It can only be a matter of time before cyber terrorism becomes a reality, and all our planning should assume that the terrorist threat will evolve in new ways, but retaining at its core a deadly intent in pursuit of an unattainable goal.

We must learn from experience and plan for the future. Our opponents show no sign of faltering in their resolve, and nor must we. Most importantly, as we strive to protect ourselves from terrorists, we must always remember that they will see and exploit any frailties or weaknesses in our defences. The overwhelming lesson of the first decade of the 21st century is that our counter-terrorist arrangements must be seamlessly coordinated and ruthlessly efficient. Nothing less will do.

Peter Clarke was the Head of Counter Terrorism at New Scotland Yard (2002-2008). He is now a member of the UK's National Security Forum, advising the government on the implementation of the National Security Strategy, and a senior adviser to the Olive Group.

